



BOOKLESSS — INTERNAL

Revenue Model & Growth Plan

Pricing structure, profitability thresholds, course rollout sequence, and team economics

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OVERVIEW

What This Model Is Built On

Booklessss delivers branded PDF study materials for Zambian university students through a Slack workspace. Revenue comes from two sources: full member subscriptions for workspace access, and per-course guest subscriptions. The model is built around Slack Business+ — one paid member seat unlocks five free single-channel guest slots.

Full members pay once and access every course channel. Guests pay per course they enroll in. Most students take four courses simultaneously, so each unique guest student generates revenue across four channels at once — the same 200-slot pool produces roughly K39,000 in guest revenue whether it holds 200 single-course students or 50 four-course students.

This document is the financial reference model. Actual performance is tracked against these projections monthly. Deviations in conversion rate, guest count, or overhead timing should be noted and the relevant phase thresholds recalculated.

PRICING

Subscription Rates

Tier	Rate	Slack type	Access	Net to platform
Full member	K390/month	Paid seat	All channels	K51 markup (seat costs K339)
Guest	K195/month	Single-channel guest	One course channel	K195 — no Slack cost

Exchange rate: K18.82 per USD. Guest rate is half the full member rate. Guests stay at K195 for one month, then upgrade to K390 or leave. The K51 markup (K390 – K339 seat cost) is platform revenue only — it does not enter the 70/30 course split.

40 full members from the launch campaign × K51 = K2,040/month fixed markup income before a single guest joins. K2,040 exceeds both Phase 1 (K1,054) and Phase 2 (K1,430) overhead — the platform is profitable from day 1 with zero guests.

ACQUISITION

Campaign Math

The campaign targets full paying members. A K10,000 budget covers both flyer printing at K20 per flyer and a K50 commission paid to the campus distributor for each student who signs up and pays. At a 10% conversion rate that yields 40 full members. Their 40 seats unlock 200 single-channel guest slots across the workspace.

Cost per flyer: K20 print + (10% × K50 commission) = K25 total per flyer

K10,000 ÷ K25 = 400 flyers distributed

400 × 10% conversion = 40 full members

40 members × 5 guest slots = 200 guest slots unlocked

Multi-course scenario: students taking 4 courses use 4 slots each

200 slots ÷ 4 = 50 unique guest students at full utilisation

Revenue: 50 × K195 × 4 courses = K39,000 vs. 200 × K195 = K39,000 (identical)

Recruiting 50 students who each take multiple courses is far easier than recruiting 200 separate people. The multi-course model lowers the acquisition target without changing the revenue ceiling.

REVENUE STRUCTURE

How Money Flows

Guest revenue moves through two stages. First, 5% comes off the top as team welfare — covering data, meals, and transport for the course team. This scales automatically as the course grows: the team eats better as guest numbers rise. The remaining 95% splits 70/30 between the course team and the platform.

Guest revenue

– 5% team welfare (data, meals, transport)

= distributable revenue

→ Course team 70%: Manager 42% + Sourcers 28%

→ Platform 30%

Platform total = Platform 30% of distributable + K2,040 full member markup

Platform net = Platform total – Overhead

The course team's 70% is never touched by overhead. The platform bears all fixed costs from its 30% share plus the markup. The team earns from the first guest — and the platform is already profitable before the first guest ever joins.

OVERHEAD

Cost Phases

Overhead is structured in four phases. With K2,040/month in markup from 40 full members, Phases 1 and 2 are both active from launch — the markup alone covers them. Phases 3 and 4 unlock as guest revenue builds past the break-even thresholds. All manager costs are platform overhead, never deducted from the team's share.

Phase	Trigger	New cost	Overhead
1 — Launch	Course opens	Founder Slack K339 + Founder Claude K376 + Manager Slack K339	K1,054
2 — Activate	Launch (day 1)	+ Manager Claude \$20 (K376) — markup covers it immediately	K1,430
3 — Scale	17 guests	+ Founder Claude upgrade to \$100 (+K1,506)	K2,936
4 — Full build	44 guests	+ Manager Claude upgrade to \$100 (+K1,506)	K4,442

PROFITABILITY

Full Model by Guest Count

Table A shows what the course team earns at each guest count. Table B shows what the platform earns, including the K2,040/month fixed markup from 40 full members. Phases 1 and 2 are profitable at zero guests. Phase 3 break-even is at 17 guests; Phase 4 at 44 guests. ✓ marks the first row where each phase covers its overhead.

Table A — Team Earnings (per course, per month)

Phases 1 & 2 — overhead K1,430 both active from launch
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Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Manager 42%	Sourcers 28%
0 ✓	K0	K0	K0	K0
10	K1,950	K98	K778	K519
20	K3,900	K195	K1,556	K1,037
30	K5,850	K293	K2,334	K1,556

Phase 3 — overhead K2,936 | upgrade founder Claude at 17 guests

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Manager 42%	Sourcers 28%
17 ✓	K3,315	K166	K1,323	K882
50	K9,750	K488	K3,891	K2,594

Phase 4 — overhead K4,442 | upgrade manager Claude at 44 guests

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Manager 42%	Sourcers 28%
44 ✓	K8,580	K429	K3,423	K2,282
100	K19,500	K975	K7,781	K5,187
200 max	K39,000	K1,950	K15,561	K10,374

Table B — Platform Economics (per course, per month)

Phases 1 & 2 — overhead K1,430 | profitable at 0 guests

Guests	Plat. 30%	Markup	Overhead	Net
0 ✓	K0	K2,040	K1,430	+K610
10	K556	K2,040	K1,430	+K1,166
20	K1,112	K2,040	K1,430	+K1,722
30	K1,667	K2,040	K1,430	+K2,277

Phase 3 — overhead K2,936 | break-even at 17 guests

Guests	Plat. 30%	Markup	Overhead	Net
17 ✓	K945	K2,040	K2,936	+K49
50	K2,779	K2,040	K2,936	+K1,883

Phase 4 — overhead K4,442 | break-even at 44 guests

Guests	Plat. 30%	Markup	Overhead	Net
44 ✓	K2,445	K2,040	K4,442	+K43
100	K5,558	K2,040	K4,442	+K3,156
200 max	K11,115	K2,040	K4,442	+K8,713

✓ = phase break-even. Net = Plat. 30% + Markup – Overhead. Plat. 30% = guests × K195 × 95% × 30% = guests × K55.58.

MILESTONES

Decision Points

Each milestone marks a threshold where the platform activates the next level of tooling. With K2,040 in monthly markup, Phases 1 and 2 are both active from launch. Only Phases 3 and 4 require guest revenue to unlock.

Guests	Trigger	Action
0 (launch)	Campaign complete — 40 full members	Open course. Activate manager Claude \$20 immediately — markup covers Phase 2 from day 1
17	Phase 3 break-even	Upgrade founder Claude to \$100 (K1,882/month). Net goes from +K1,883 to +K49 then builds
44	Phase 4 break-even	Upgrade manager Claude to \$100 (K1,882/month). Net goes from +K3,156 to +K43 then builds
200	All slots filled	K8,713 net, team earning K27,885 — open waitlist for next course

ROLLOUT

Course Launch Sequence

No course opens without at least one confirmed guest commitment — this confirms real demand before hiring a manager. The threshold is low because the K2,040 markup already covers all overhead through Phase 2 from launch.

Course	Min. guests	Why
Course 1	1 committed	K2,040 markup > K1,054 overhead — profitable immediately
Course 2	1 committed	K2,040 > K1,393 (adds K339 manager seat) — still covered by markup
Course 3	1 committed	K2,040 > K1,732 (adds another K339) — still covered
Course 4	1 committed	K2,040 vs K2,071 (adds third K339) — K31 gap, covered by 1 guest

Rollout sequence:

Campaign → 40 full members (200 guest slots unlocked)

→ Waitlist opens for Course 1

→ 1 guest committed → Course 1 launches, manager hired

→ Waitlist opens for Course 2

→ 1 guest committed → Course 2 launches, manager hired

→ Repeat for Courses 3 and 4

At four courses running with 50 four-course students: K39,000/month total guest revenue.

TEAM

Course Team Structure

Each course has one matched team. The Manager handles everything for that course — content delivery, community management, and marketing. Sourcers bring in source material and student referrals. Manager and Sourcers apply for a specific course and are matched before launch. No person crosses courses.

Manager: 42% of distributable guest revenue

Sourcers: 28% of distributable guest revenue (split among the sourcing team)

Welfare: 5% of gross guest revenue (data, meals, transport — off the top)

At 200 guests max: Manager K15,561 + Sourcers K10,374 + Welfare K1,950 = K27,885 to team

Welfare is not a fixed amount — it grows with the course. At 10 guests the pool is K98. At 200 guests it is K1,950. Data stays covered throughout. Meals and transport become meaningful as the course matures and in-person sessions become regular.

All platform overhead — founder Slack, founder Claude, manager Slack seat, manager Claude — is borne by the platform from its 30% share and the full member markup. The course team's 70% is never reduced by overhead at any stage.

PAYMENT CADENCE

Weekly Team Payouts

Students pay monthly. The team gets paid weekly. Each student payment received during the week is split immediately and batched into a single Friday mobile money transfer to the Manager and Sourcers. No waiting until month-end.

Per student payment received:

K195 × 5% = K9.75 welfare (retained for team data/meals/transport pool)

K195 × 95% = K185.25 distributable

→ **Manager 42% = K77.81**

→ **Sourcers 28% = K51.87 (divided among sourcing team)**

→ **Platform 30% = K55.58 (retained by platform)**

Weekly Payout by Batch Size

If N students pay in the same week, multiply by N. Payments trickle across the month — some weeks are heavier than others. Pay what came in that week. Do not hold.

Guests paid	Gross	Welfare	Manager	Sourcers	Platform share
1	K195	K9.75	K77.81	K51.87	K55.58
5	K975	K48.75	K389.03	K259.35	K277.88
10	K1,950	K97.50	K778.05	K518.70	K555.75
20	K3,900	K195	K1,556.10	K1,037.40	K1,111.50
50	K9,750	K487.50	K3,890.25	K2,593.50	K2,778.75

Full member markup (K2,040/month) goes entirely to the platform and is not distributed weekly to the team. Transfer it to the platform account once per month as members pay their subscriptions.

How to run it each Friday:

1. Open your payment log (WhatsApp thread or spreadsheet)
2. Sum all guest payments received Monday–Friday
3. Apply the formula: $\text{Gross} \times 95\% \times 42\% \rightarrow \text{Manager}$, $\times 28\% \rightarrow \text{Sourcers}$
4. Transfer via Airtel/MTN Mobile Money — same day
5. Log: 'Week ending [date] — [N] payments — Manager K[X] sent ✓'

Keep every transfer receipt. This is the record actual performance is measured against.

Weekly payments are motivating and low-risk. You only pay money already received — there is no float or advance. If a student is late paying, that week's batch is simply smaller. The formula never changes.